Archery Safety Rules and Regulations

Annexure IV. Construction and registration of Bachos and safety measures to protect archers and the public from stray arrows.

A. Construction of a Bacho

1. Ideally 200 m long and 20 m wide, leaving a safe distance of 25 m behind each target area.
2. No public thoroughfare or vehicle parking within this area.
3. Where 200 m is not possible, a 6 m wall topped with 2 m of fine wire mesh behind each target area, at least 7 m wide.
4. If no spectators are expected the width may be reduced to 10 m (shooting area only); where spectators are expected, the shooting area should be at least 15 m wide.
5. Archer safety barriers at least 8 ft long and 7 ft high on both sides of the Bacho.
6. Perimeter fencing in urban or populated areas, warning signboards, and any further measures the location requires.

B. Registration of Bachos

1. Ranges within urban or municipal areas are registered with the city or municipal corporation after inspection against these criteria.
2. Ranges outside municipal boundaries are registered with the Dzongkhag or Gewog administration.
3. New ranges are approved only if they meet BIGSA’s criteria.

C. Other safety measures

1. An archer who draws sideways, threatening spectators, may not take part in games or tournaments.
2. Drink-shooting is not allowed at any range; officials, caretakers, owners and team captains enforce this.
3. An archer whose arrow hits someone outside the prescribed area is fully liable and may be banned; an archer involved in a fatal accident is banned for life.
4. Learners should not shoot at ranges, games or matches where public or player safety is a concern.
5. No spectators within the 10 m shooting area; every archer stays alert to avoid being hit.